



Trainee Worksheet 3

Telephone English for Admin Staff

Practical tasks, role-plays and message-taking

★ Today's mission

You do not need to understand every word on the phone. You need to ask, check, write down and confirm the important information.

✓ Learning goals

- Answer a professional phone call using clear opening phrases.
- Ask who is calling and what the call is about.
- Ask for repetition, spelling and slower speech when needed.
- Take a complete telephone message on a message pad.
- Confirm key information before ending the call.
- Pass on a short message to a colleague clearly.

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◆ Quick confidence check

Tick how you feel now. Be honest - this is only to help you learn.

I can...	Not yet	With help	Confident
answer a call in English	☐	☐	☐
ask for the caller's name	☐	☐	☐
ask someone to repeat/spell	☐	☐	☐
take a short phone message	☐	☐	☐

📞 Activity 1 - Telephone phrase match

→ Instructions

Match each situation to the best professional phrase. Write the correct letter in the answer column.

Letter	Phrase
A	Could you spell that, please?
B	Let me repeat that.
C	Good morning. Administration Department. How can I help you?
D	Can I take a message?
E	Who's calling, please?
F	Could you repeat that, please?

Situation	Answer	Useful note
You answer the phone.	_____	Use a professional opening.
You need the caller's name.	_____	Be polite and brief.
You do not understand.	_____	Ask for repetition.
You need the spelling of a name.	_____	Ask them to spell it.
The person is not available.	_____	Offer to take a message.
You want to check the details.	_____	Repeat the key information.

✉ Activity 2 - The structure of a professional phone call

★ Instructions

Read the call structure. Highlight 5 phrases you want to use today.

→ 1. Open the call

- Good morning. Administration Department. How can I help you?
- Good afternoon. This is Ana speaking.
- Hello, Reception. How may I help you?

→ 2. Identify the caller

- Who's calling, please?
- Could I have your name, please?
- What company are you calling from?

→ 3. Identify the reason

- Who would you like to speak to?
- What is the call about?
- Can I ask what it is about?

→ 4. Clarify and check

- Sorry, could you repeat that, please?
- Could you speak more slowly, please?
- Could you spell that, please?
- Let me check that.

→ 5. Take the message

- Can I take a message?
- Would you like to leave a message?
- I'll ask him/her to call you back.

→ 6. Confirm and close

- Let me repeat that.
- So, your number is...
- I'll pass on the message.
- Thank you for calling. Goodbye.

☎ Model call - read and notice

✓ Mini-task

Underline the questions the receptionist asks. Circle the clarification phrase.

Receptionist: Good morning. Administration Department. How can I help you?

Caller: Hello. This is Daniel Martins from GreenLine Supplies.

Receptionist: Could you spell your surname, please?

Caller: Yes, M-A-R-T-I-N-S.

Receptionist: Thank you. Who would you like to speak to?

Caller: I'd like to speak to Ms Ferreira, please.

Receptionist: She's not available at the moment. Can I take a message?

Caller: Yes, please. Could you ask her to call me back about tomorrow's delivery?

Receptionist: Of course. Could I have your number, please?

Caller: Yes, it's 912 456 783.

Receptionist: Let me repeat that: 912 456 783.

Caller: That's right. Thank you.

Receptionist: I'll pass on the message. Goodbye.

Activity 3 - Listening: take the message

→ Instructions

Your trainer will read a short phone call. Listen twice and complete the message pad. Then compare with a partner.

Message pad 1

Caller name	_____
Company	_____
Person to speak to	_____
Reason for calling	_____
Phone number / extension	_____
Action needed	_____
Important details	_____

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Message pad 2

Caller name	_____
Company	_____
Person to speak to	_____
Reason for calling	_____
Phone number / extension	_____
Action needed	_____
Important details	_____

★ Message writing model

Daniel Martins from GreenLine Supplies called about tomorrow's delivery. Please call him back on 912 456 783.

✓ Activity 4 - Pronunciation and clarification clinic

→ Instructions

Work in pairs. Student A says or spells the information. Student B writes it down and checks it. Then switch roles.

A. Names and companies

- ☐ Brown & Miller
- ☐ GreenLine Supplies
- ☐ Martins
- ☐ Ferreira
- ☐ Costa & Co.
- ☐ NovaTech
- ☐ Bright Office
- ☐ Silva Logistics

B. Numbers and extensions

- ☐ 912 456 783
- ☐ 213 780 445
- ☐ 964 112 509
- ☐ 221 406 700
- ☐ extension 214
- ☐ extension 305

When you need...

repetition / slower speech / spelling / checking

Say...

Could you repeat that, please?
Could you speak more slowly, please?
Could you spell that, please?
Let me check that: ... Is that correct?

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📞 Activity 5 - Controlled role-play: receptionist and caller

→ Instructions

Work in pairs. One trainee is the receptionist and one trainee is the caller. Use the call flow, the useful phrases and the caller cards. Then switch roles.

✓ Receptionist flow

Step	What to say / do
1	Open the call: Good morning. Administration Department. How can I help you?
2	Ask for the caller's name and company.
3	Ask who they would like to speak to.
4	Ask what the call is about.
5	Ask for spelling/repetition if needed.
6	Take the message and phone number/extension.

🔗 Caller cards - choose one

Caller Card 1

You are Sofia Almeida from NovaTech.
You want to speak to Mr Costa.
Reason: invoice number 458 is incorrect.
Phone number: 934 775 210.
Message: Please call back today.

Caller Card 2

You are Mark Wilson from Bright Office.
You want to speak to Ms Lopes.
Reason: meeting time changed from 10:00 to 11:30.
Phone number: 213 400 872.
Message: Please confirm the new time.

Caller Card 3

You are Helena Duarte from OfficePlus.
You want to speak to Human Resources.
Reason: interview appointment.
Phone number: 221 406 700.
Message: Please confirm the room number.

Caller Card 4 - Challenge

You are Victor Brown from Brown & Miller.
You want to speak to Mr Almeida.
Reason: contract documents.
Phone number: 213 780 445.
Correction during the call: not Brown, Browne with E.
Message: Please send the updated document today.

☎ Activity 6 - Back-to-back telephone challenge

→ Instructions

Sit back-to-back with your partner. The caller reads a card. The receptionist listens, asks questions and completes the message pad. Do not show the card.

✓ Rules

- The receptionist cannot look at the caller card.
- The receptionist must ask for repetition or spelling if needed.
- The receptionist must repeat the key details before closing the call.
- Compare the message pad with the caller card at the end.

Back-to-back message pad 1

Caller name	_____
Company	_____
Person/department	_____
Reason	_____
Number/extension	_____
Message/action	_____
Check: Did I repeat it? ☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	_____

Back-to-back message pad 2

Caller name	_____
Company	_____
Person/department	_____
Reason	_____
Number/extension	_____
Message/action	_____
Check: Did I repeat it? ☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	_____

★ Useful survival language

Sorry, could you repeat that? | Could you speak more slowly? | Could you spell that? | Let me repeat that. | Is that correct?

Activity 7 - Read and repair: bad message notes

→ Instructions

Read the poor message notes. What is missing? Rewrite one message in a clear professional way.

Bad note	What is missing?	Improved message
Daniel called. Delivery. Call him.	_____ _____ _____	_____ _____ _____ _____
Ms Lopes meeting changed.	_____ _____ _____	_____ _____ _____ _____
Finance payment.	_____ _____ _____	_____ _____ _____ _____

★ Activity 8 - Final integrated task: take and pass on a message

→ Instructions

Work in groups of 3: Caller, Receptionist and Colleague. Complete the three steps below.

Step	What to do
1	Caller phones reception. Receptionist answers, asks questions and takes the message.
2	Receptionist passes the message orally to the colleague.
3	Colleague checks: Is the message complete and clear?

Handover language

- Sofia Almeida from NovaTech called.
- She wants to speak to Mr Costa.
- It is about invoice number 458.
- She asked you to call her back today.
- Her number is 934 775 210.

Scenario A

Caller: You are Paulo Mendes from PrintMax. You need to speak to Ms Ribeiro about a missing order.
Phone: 912 340 766. Message: Please call back before lunch.

Scenario B

Caller: You are Laura Green from TechPoint. You need to speak to IT Support about a password reset.
Extension: 208. Message: Please email the instructions today.

Scenario C

Caller: You are Ana Torres from Alpha Training. You need to speak to the Administration Department about Friday's meeting. Phone: 213 552 900. Message: The meeting starts at 9:30, not 10:00.

Your final message note:

Caller	_____
Company	_____
For	_____
Reason	_____
Contact details	_____
Message/action	_____

★ Useful phrase bank - keep this page!

Opening	Good morning. Administration Department. How can I help you? Good afternoon. This is ___ speaking.
Asking for details	Who's calling, please? What company are you calling from? Who would you like to speak to? What is the call about?
Clarifying	Could you repeat that, please? Could you spell that, please? Could you speak more slowly, please?
Taking a message	Can I take a message? Would you like to leave a message? I'll ask him/her to call you back.
Confirming and closing	Let me repeat that. So, your number is... I'll pass on the message. Thank you for calling. Goodbye.
Passing on the message	___ from ___ called. It is about ____. He/She asked you to ____. His/Her number is ____.

✓ Exit ticket - quick reflection

→ Instructions

Complete this before you leave. Use short answers.

Today I practised...	_____ _____
One useful telephone phrase is...	_____ _____
I can now...	_____ _____
I still need help with...	_____ _____
Telephone English is difficult because...	_____ _____
My confidence after today: ☐ Not yet ☐ With help ☐ Better ☐ Confident	_____ _____

✂ Extra caller cards - optional practice

★ Instructions

Use these if you finish early or need another practice round.

Extra Card 1 You are Sara Oliveira from NovaEvents. You want to speak to Ms Carvalho. Reason: room booking for Monday. Phone: 934 220 118. Message: Please confirm the booking.	Extra Card 2 You are Tom Harris from CloudDesk. You want to speak to the manager. Reason: software update appointment. Phone: 213 600 455. Message: The technician will arrive at 2:30.
Extra Card 3 You are Carla Nunes from PaperWorld. You want to speak to Purchasing. Reason: new catalogue. Extension: 407. Message: Please check your email.	Extra Card 4 - Challenge You are David Lee from SmartPay. You want to speak to Finance. Reason: invoice 703. Phone: 221 777 980. During the call, correct the time: not 3:15, 3:50.

Remember: ask, check, write down, confirm.